QP CODE—26900430

SCHEME

MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP(Honours) /MGU-BCA(Honours)

REGULAR EXAMINATION October 2026

Fifth Semester

DSE-MG5DSEPOL302—POLITICAL SOCIOLOGY OF MODERN INDIA

Duration: 2 hours **Maximum. Marks—70**

Part-A

1. Political Sociology
2. Ethnicity
3. Mazdoor Kisan Shakti Sangathan (MKSS)
4. Social Welfare Policies
5. Brain Drain
6. Political Party
7. Wealth/Property/Income/Occupation.
8. Leadership/Leader
9. Foreign Direct Investment
10. Caste/Caste system.

Part-B

11. Elite-A small, resource-controlling minority possessing disproportionate wealth, institutional authority, skills, or status----Masses--The vast, unorganized, and largely powerless majority of the population—Elites influences policies and political decisions—masses participate mainly through elections and social movements
12. Max Weber 's multi-dimensional theory of social stratification---status, class, party—status social honour, prestige, or respect a person or group is granted by others---status based on lifestyle—education—occupation—social recognition—it influences social inequality and political opportunities.
13. Mobilisation in social movements refers to the process by which a group gathers, coordinates, and deploys resources, people, and networks to achieve collective goals or effect social change
14. Social transformation is a profound, fundamental, and long-lasting shift in the structures, institutions, values, norms, and power dynamics of a society. —change in values—norms—relationships.
15. Indian sociologist—concept of Sanskritization—concept of Westernisation—theory of dominant caste—study of caste social mobility village society political power---Analysed how democratic processes and universal adult franchise intersected with traditional rural leadership, introducing the concept of vote banks
16. The gendered division of labour is the assignment of different tasks, jobs, and responsibilities to men and women based on socially constructed gender roles---Women’s unpaid domestic work—gender inequality in employment, opportunities---Patriarchy and the need for gender equality.

17. Land and forest rights form the core of Adivasi (indigenous) movements representing a struggle for physical survival, cultural identity, self-governance, and resistance against historical and modern displacement----Adivasi movements for identity autonomy and social justice—land and forest are essential for Adivasis livelihood---The Forest Rights Act (FRA), 2006----Gram Sabha as a Weapon of Resistance---Constitutional Protections.
18. Agrarian movements are collective struggles by rural populations—including small peasants, tenants, landless agricultural laborers, and rich farmers—to challenge exploitative structures and secure control over land and livelihood. Land is not merely an economic asset; it is the foundation of social identity, survival, and autonomy in rural societies.
19. The liberal approach to political sociology centres on the individual as the primary actor in society, viewing political institutions and social structures as mechanisms meant to protect personal freedom, foster cooperation, and limit state power---political pluralism—political participation—rule of law.
20. The Marxist approach in political sociology views politics, the state, and power not as independent or neutral spheres, but as direct reflections of a society's underlying economic and material conditions---state as an instrument of class domination—historical materialism—capitalist exploitation.

Part-C

21. Political sociology in India emerged as a distinct interdisciplinary field following independence in 1947--Pre-Independence Foundations (Colonial Era to 1947)--- Colonial Ethnography and Administration---Institutional Emergence---National Awakening and Reform--Post-Independence Institutionalization (1950s–1960s)-- Bridging Political Science and Sociology---Foundational Professional Bodies-- The formation of the Indian Sociological Society in 1951--The Dominant Caste and Village Power--M.N. Srinivas introduced crucial frameworks such as thedominant caste and vote bank---The Golden Era of Politicization Studies (1970s–1980s)-- The Politicization of Caste----Tradition and Modernity Debates---Agrarian Class and Structural Analyses--Democratic Upsurges and Identity Politics (1990s–2000s)--- The First and Second Democratic Upsurges--Decoupling Ritual and Political Power--Political Society vs. Civil Society--Contemporary Trends --Aspirational Politics and Beneficiary Bases----Interdisciplinary Expansion.
22. Meaning of Linguistic diversity—multilingual character of India society—constitutional recognition—protection of languages—official language policy in India—linguistic recognition of states---language and regional identity—linguistic nationalism---regional political movements—role of language in political mobilisation—language based political parties—challenges to linguistic diversity—contribution to democratic pluralism.
23. Digital platforms transform public opinion and political mobilisation by bypassing traditional media gatekeepers, enabling direct leader-to-citizen communication, and lowering the barriers to collective action, while simultaneously accelerating polarization, echo chambers, and the spread of misinformation-----Digital connectivity empowers ordinary citizens and marginalized communities to organize social movements, protest campaigns, and civic activities online that rapidly translate into offline--Direct Leader-Public Connectivity--Hybrid Campaigning--Reactive Public Discourse etc..
24. Political economy is an interdisciplinary social science that studies how political institutions, power dynamics, and legal frameworks mutually influence economic systems, market behaviour, and the distribution of wealth and resources---scope in globalisation--State-Market Relations--Power Asymmetries and Class Dynamics--Institutional and Regulatory Frameworks--Policy Choices and Resistance--Crisis Management—Limitations--State-Centric Bias—Reductionism-Difficulty in Quantifying Cultural and Psychological Factors---Pace and Complexity of Technological Disruption---Predictive Weakness—insufficient attention to culture—identity gender and environmental factors.